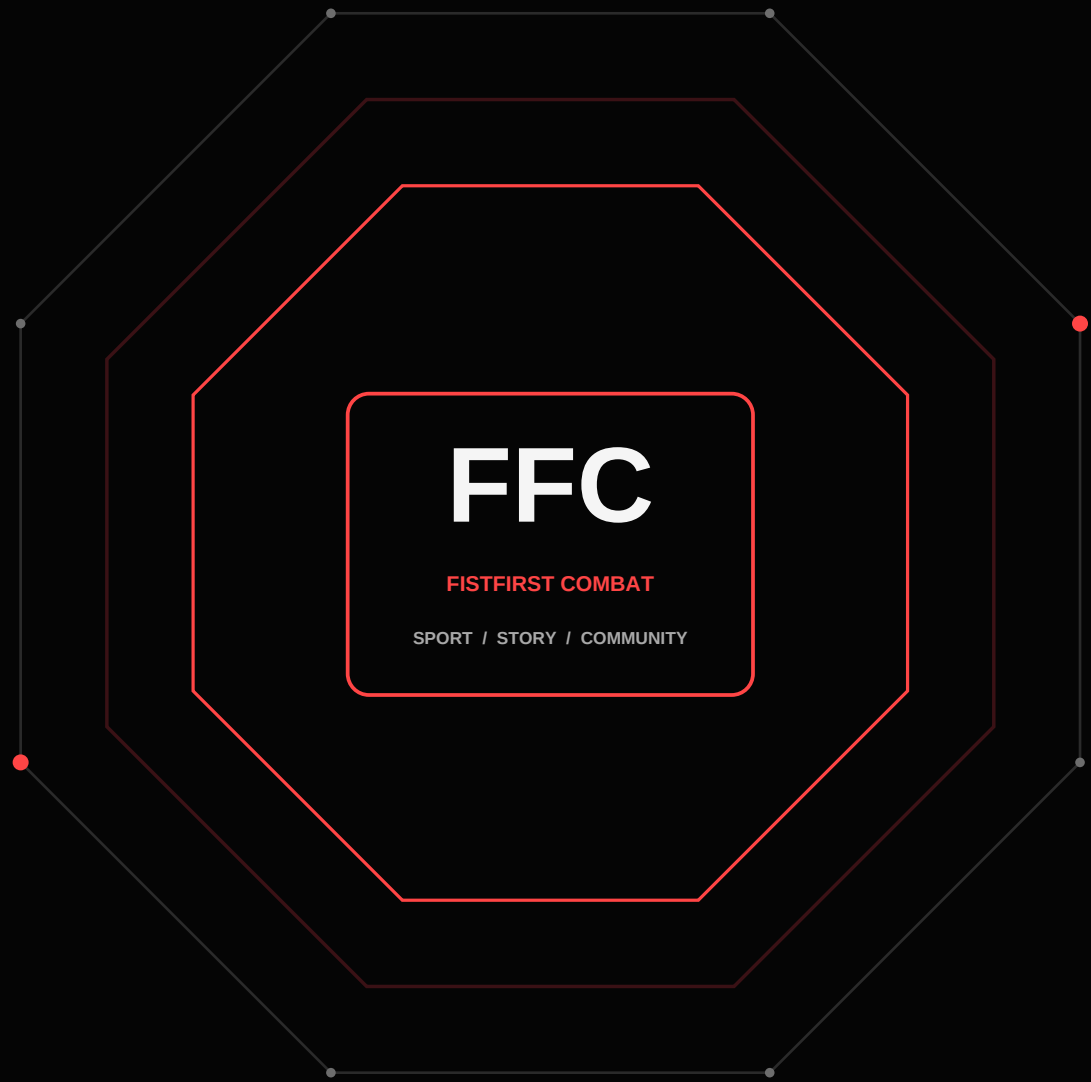
CASE STUDY 10 / SPORTS ENTERTAINMENT VENTURE

FISTFIRST COMBAT

Building the concept for an MMA promotion

A venture concept built around competitive intensity, fighter narratives and the shared energy of live combat sports.



PROJECT STATUS

CONCEPTUAL STAGE / NOT LAUNCHED

INDEPENDENT VENTURE CONCEPT

Not affiliated with NoBroker Loans

A promotion, not just a fight card

The idea was to explore how brand identity, live events, fighter stories and community could work together as one sports-entertainment proposition.

CORE THESIS

Build a recognisable MMA platform that gives each event a larger narrative.

The promotion concept connects competitive sport with the stories around it: the athletes, rivalries, preparation, event atmosphere and fans who follow the journey.

01 BRAND

A distinct identity for the promotion.

02 EVENT

Live fights as the core audience experience.

03 STORY

Athlete narratives that give people a reason to care.

POSITIONING INTENT

A cohesive sports-entertainment brand around competitive intensity and human stories.

Five foundations for a differentiated promotion

The concept considered the components needed to make FFC recognisable and relevant beyond an individual bout or event announcement.

01 BRAND POSITIONING

Establish a distinct identity within the combat-sports landscape.

02 EVENT-LED ENGAGEMENT

Make live fight events the central audience experience.

03 FIGHTER STORYTELLING

Create space for athlete journeys, rivalries and preparation narratives.

04 COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT

Build a shared point of connection for fans and participants.

05 COMMERCIAL POTENTIAL

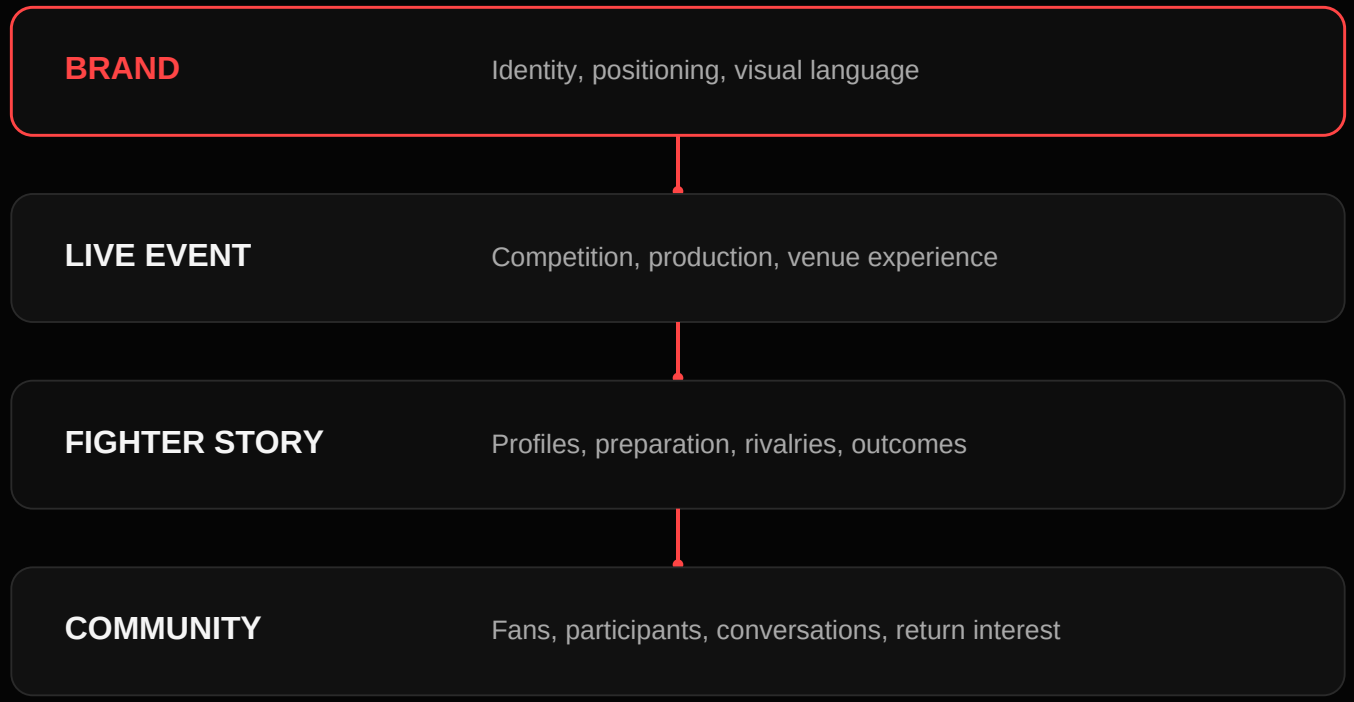
Explore partnerships, sponsorship, content and merchandise as possible extensions.

STRATEGIC QUESTION

What could make FFC memorable before, during and after an event?

Four connected layers make the proposition

The concept explored a connected system: a brand creates recognition, the event delivers the live experience, stories extend attention, and community sustains interest.



THE SYSTEM EFFECT

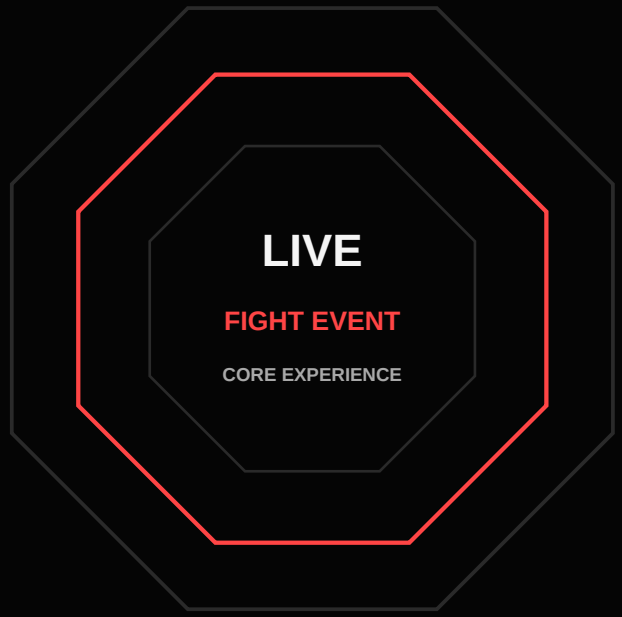
Each layer should reinforce the others.

A brand helps the event stand out. The event creates stories. Stories give the community something to follow. Community can help build anticipation for what comes next.

ONE PLATFORM / MULTIPLE TOUCHPOINTS

The event is the core product moment

Live competition was envisioned as the anchor experience, with the wider brand system designed to build meaning around it.



BEFORE

Build anticipation

Fighter profiles, matchup context, event narrative.

DURING

Deliver the moment

Competition, audience energy, production and experience.

AFTER

Extend the story

Results, reflections, next narratives and community discussion.

DESIGN INTENT Treat every event as one chapter in a broader promotion story, not a standalone fixture.

Give audiences reasons to follow the journey

The concept considered how interest could extend beyond the live event through story-led communication and community touchpoints.

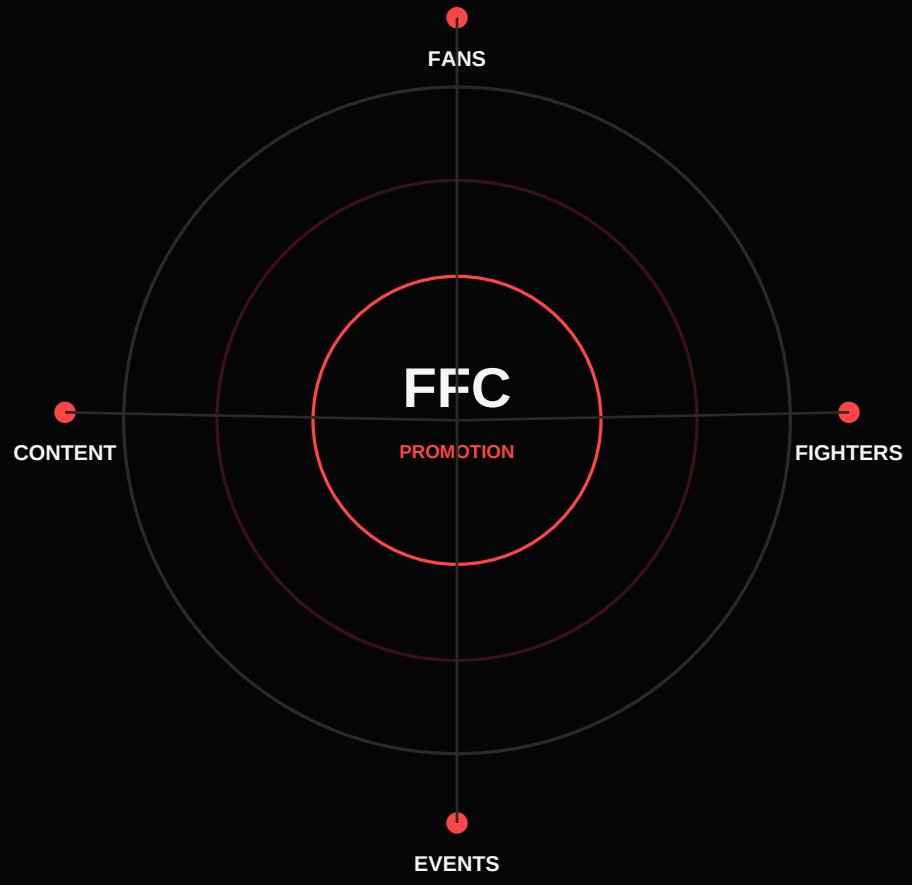
THE STORY LAYER

Beyond the result.

A fight has a result. A compelling sports property also gives people context: who the athletes are, what is at stake, how preparation unfolds and what the result means for the next chapter.

POTENTIAL CONTENT TERRITORIES

- Athlete profiles and origin stories
- Training, preparation and mindset
- Matchup context and post-event reflection



COMMUNITY IS AN INTENDED DESIGN PILLAR, NOT A MEASURED AUDIENCE OUTCOME.

Map the possibilities without overclaiming

The venture concept identified potential commercial extensions. These are areas to explore, not secured revenue streams or partnerships.

EVENT PARTNERSHIPS

Potential collaboration with venues, local partners and event-support businesses.

SPONSORSHIP

Brand partnerships aligned with the audience, sport and event format.

CONTENT

Digital storytelling and media formats that extend event narratives.

MERCHANDISE

Branded products that can deepen affinity and event identity.

COMMERCIAL DISCIPLINE

Validate audience demand, event economics and partner fit before scaling.

A disciplined path to test the venture

A potential next-step sequence for moving the concept from strategic direction toward evidence-based decisions.

01

DEFINE

Positioning, audience, differentiation and the event proposition.

02

VALIDATE

Research audience demand, competitive context and operating requirements.

03

DESIGN

Outline format, production needs, safety, venue, talent and partner criteria.

04

PILOT

Develop a small, responsible proof of concept only after feasibility is established.

05

LEARN

Evaluate audience response, costs, delivery quality and commercial assumptions.

IMPORTANT GATE **Concept validation should precede commitments to fighters, venues, sponsors or live events.**

Roadmap shown as a proposed path, not a record of completed execution.

A concept with room to become a brand.

FistFirst Combat explored the foundations of an MMA promotion built around competition, storytelling and community.

VENTURE

Venture conceptualisation

Brand positioning and differentiation

AUDIENCE

Sports entertainment strategy

Audience and community development

COMMERCIAL

Event-led marketing strategy

Commercial opportunity mapping

PROJECT STATUS / CONCEPTUAL STAGE

This case study documents the venture concept and strategic direction. It does not claim that events were launched, fighters signed, sponsors acquired or commercial results achieved.

INDEPENDENT VENTURE CONCEPT / NOT PART OF NOBROKER LOANS